According to the same Act, the sumptuary allowance is paid to the Speaker of the Lok Sabha at the same rate as is payable to a Cabinet Minister[9b] (i.e., ₹2,000 per month). Likewise, the sumptuary allowance is paid to the Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha and the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha at the same rate as is payable to a Minister of State (i.e., ₹1000 per month).

PRESIDING OFFICERS OF PARLIAMENT

Each House of Parliament has its own presiding officer. There is a Speaker and a Deputy Speaker for the Lok Sabha and a Chairman and a Deputy Chairman for the Rajya Sabha. A panel of chairpersons for the Lok Sabha and a panel of vice-chairpersons for the Rajya Sabha is also appointed.

 **Speaker of Lok Sabha**

Election and Tenure The Speaker is elected by the Lok Sabha from amongst its members (as soon as may be, after its first sitting). Whenever the office of the Speaker falls vacant, the Lok Sabha elects another member to fill the vacancy. The date of election of the Speaker is fixed by the President.

Usually, the Speaker remains in office during the life of the Lok Sabha. However, he/she has to vacate his/her office earlier in any of the following three cases:

1. if he/she ceases to be a member of the Lok Sabha;
2. if he/she resigns by writing to the Deputy Speaker; and
3. if he/she is removed by a resolution passed by a majority of all the then members of the Lok Sabha (i.e., an effective majority). Such a resolution can be moved only after giving 14 days' advance notice.

When a resolution for the removal of the Speaker is under consideration of the House, he/she cannot preside at the sitting of the House, though he/she may be present. However, he/she can speak and take part in the proceedings of the House at such a time and vote in the first instance, though not in the case of an equality of votes.

It should be noted here that, whenever the Lok Sabha is dissolved, the Speaker does not vacate his/her office and continues till the newly-elected Lok Sabha meets.

The tenure of the Speakers of the Lok Sabha (from first to present) is mentioned in Table 23.7.

Role, Powers and Functions The Speaker is the head of the Lok Sabha, and its representative. He/she is the guardian of powers and privileges of the members, the House as a whole and its committees. He/she is the principal spokesperson of the House, and his/her decision is final in all Parliamentary matters. He/she is thus much more than merely the presiding officer of the Lok Sabha. In these capacities, he/she is vested with vast, varied and vital responsibilities and enjoys great honour, high dignity and supreme authority within the House.

The Speaker of the Lok Sabha derives his/her powers and duties from three sources, that is, the Constitution of India, the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business of Lok Sabha, and Parliamentary Conventions (residuary powers that are unwritten or unspecified in the Rules). Altogether, he/she has the following powers and duties: